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When Anyone Can Build AI and a Bolder Entrepreneurial Spirit

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Growth and Welfare



GROWTH

Needs people who take risks





WELFARE

Gives people security

Opposites?

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Does security erode the will to challenge?

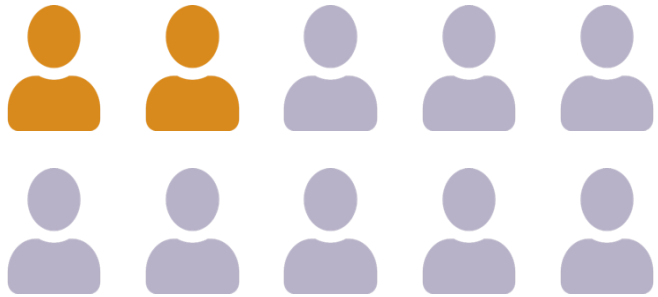
Growth vs. Welfare: Rekindling the Spirit of Challenge and Innovation

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Young Koreans on the Sidelines

14.6% ➡ **22.3%**

2019 2025



About 1 in 5 young adults

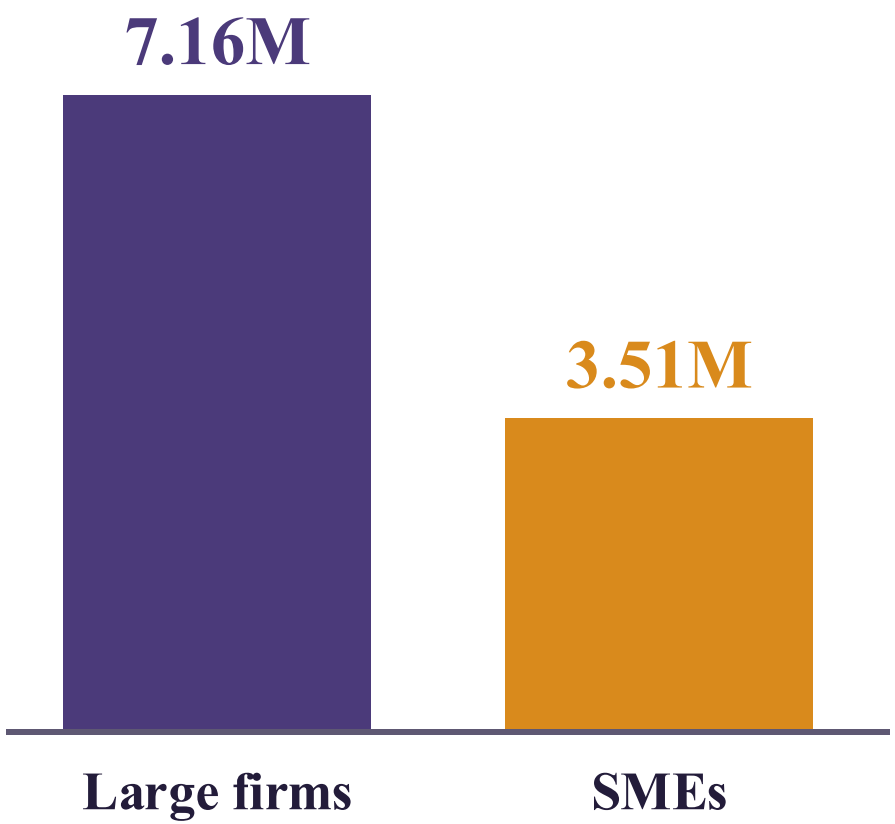
Ages 20 to 34, “resting”: not working, studying, or job hunting

Not picky: their wage expectations were not especially high

Source: Bank of Korea, January 2026

Why Playing It Safe Makes Sense

Average monthly wage, 2024 (won)



5 to 6%

of moves in their 20s: SME to large firm

Waiting is a rational choice

Source: Korea Institute for Industrial Economics and Trade (KIET), 2026

Fear Is Not the Difference

Fear would stop them (2023)



Starting a business (2024)



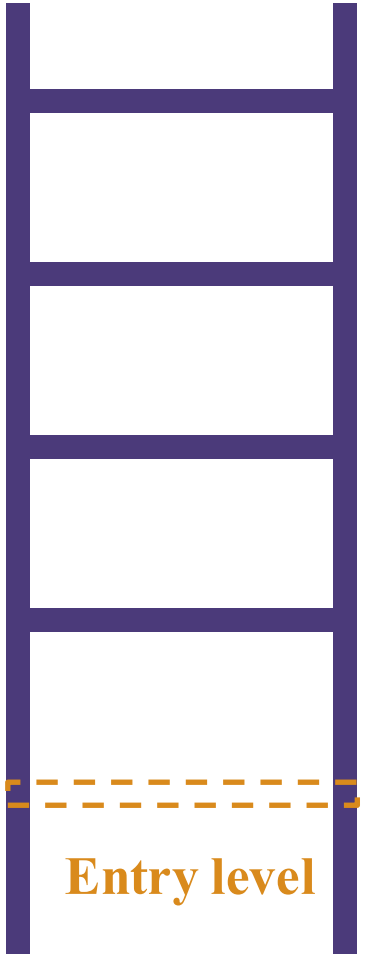
What differs: how long failure follows you

- Loan guarantees
- Credit damage
- Family expectations

Now changing: joint-liability reforms and restart funds

Sources: Global Entrepreneurship Monitor, 2023 and 2024; Korea Ministry of SMEs and Startups, 2025

AI and the First Rung of the Ladder



1 in 5

US companies have frozen entry-level hiring because of AI

Nearly half expect to by 2027

IBM: tripling US entry-level hiring in 2026

No juniors today means no managers tomorrow

So IBM is redesigning junior roles around AI

Sources: Resume.org survey of 933 US business leaders, February 2026; IBM

Security and Challenge

2019 · Journal of Management Inquiry

"Universal Basic Income and Entrepreneurial Pursuit in an Autonomous Society"

When survival pressure eases, motivation and creativity grow

Meaningful work

More experimentation

Risk opens to everyone

Questions for My 2027 Sabbatical

Effort	Can security and AI make a challenge feel less steep?
Culture	How does culture, including Korea's, shape risk-taking?
Purpose	What gives work meaning when AI takes over tasks?

With philosopher Melissa Fitzpatrick · **Partners in Korea welcome**

Two Levers

SECURITY

lowers the cost of failure

AI

lowers the cost of trying

Will to challenge

When Trying Gets Cheaper

≈ 3,000

people applied to Zoom's Solopreneur 50 in 2026

Most already run revenue-generating businesses of one, powered by AI

For employers: your best people may create their own challenge

Source: Zoom, "Rise of the Solopreneur," May 2026

LION SHARE

A campus guide to giving back in Los Angeles, built by LMU students

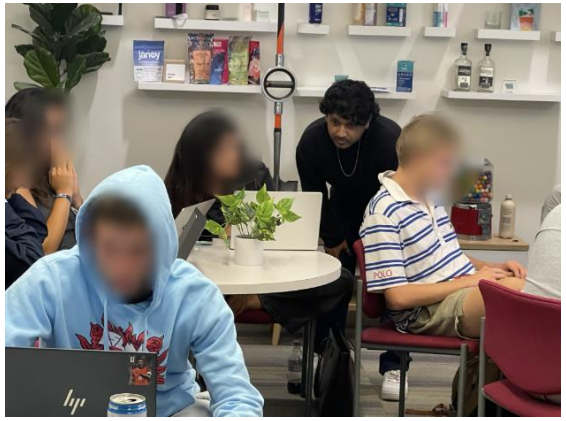
Pick a cause › **Build with an AI helper** › **Help people show up**

BUILT BY LMU STUDENTS | FOR LOS ANGELES | NO CODING NEEDED

LionShare: Built in One Class

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90 minutes

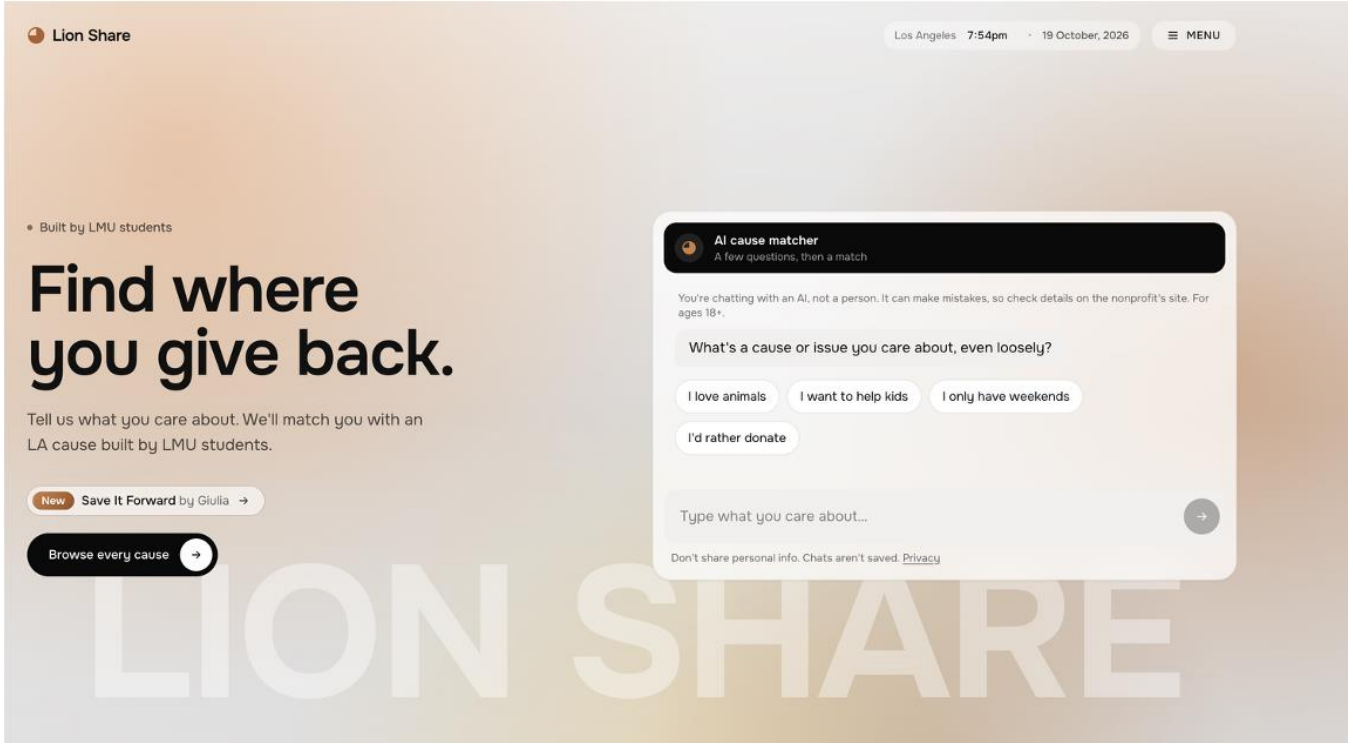
21 nonprofit pages

Most students new to coding

Co-designed with Abhi Chatterjee

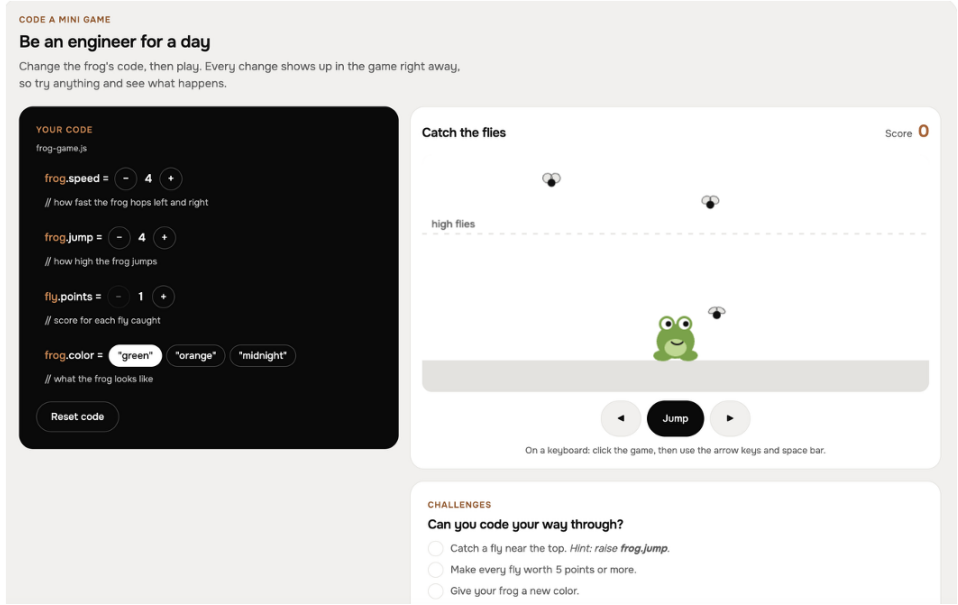
What the Students Built

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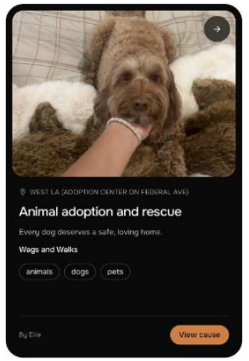


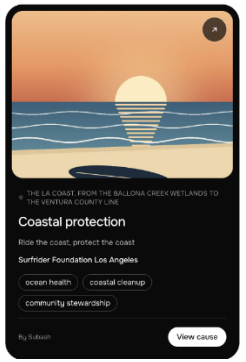
AI cause matcher: tell it what you care about

Every page built by a student, in one class



Mini apps: code a game, then play





21

cause pages

The Cost of Trying Has Collapsed

Before AI

- 4 to 6 months
- $75,000 to $150,000
- A professional team

In our class

- 90 minutes
- Students + AI agents
- No coding required

What they really built: the confidence to try

Second Chances Build Great Companies

Lee Seung-gun

8 failures in 5 years

↓

Toss

≈ 30M registered users

Kim Bong-jin

Furniture firm failed
200M+ won in debt

↓

Baemin

Sold for $4.3 billion

Joon Yu

A VPN, then an ad blocker

↓

Ad-Shield

100B+ won recovered a year

Each had enough room to recover

Three Pathways for Leaders

Pathway	What HR leaders can do
Make failure recoverable	Value failed projects; welcome people back
Make trying easier	Keep entry-level jobs; offer AI build days
Widen who gets to try	Recruit and train beyond the usual pipeline

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Security lowers the cost of failure.
AI lowers the cost of trying.

When anyone can build, who will dare to start?

Thank you · 감사합니다

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